British India · The First Stamps

Scinde District Dawk · 1 July 1852

½a

SG S1
½a white

SG S2
½a blue

SG S3
½a scarlet





The 1854 Lithographs · Calcutta

½a blue
Queen Victoria

1a red

2a green

4a blue and red
first bicolour

The Scinde Dawk, issued by Sir Bartle Frere, was the first postage stamp of Asia. The design was embossed without colour on white paper, on blue paper, or on a scarlet wafer of sealing wax — which cracks easily, so good copies are scarce.